

Sean Taylor

Cell: (973) 444-0135 | staylor@santamonicabay.org | 1236 Manhattan Beach Blvd Apt B,
Manhattan Beach CA 90266

EDUCATION

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona *2025 - Present*

- M.S. in Biology
- Claisse Lab

University of Southern California, Los Angeles *2022*

- B.S. in Environmental Studies; Minor: Marine Biology
- 3.51 Cumulative GPA; 3.72 Major GPA

EXPERIENCE

The Bay Foundation *September 2022 – Present*

Program Manager – Ocean Resiliency Program *November 2025 – Present*

- Manage and lead dive teams for subtidal scientific diving project focused on *Macrocystis pyrifera* (giant kelp) restoration, endangered and threatened *Haliotis* species (abalone) recovery, and *Zostera* species (eelgrass) research
- Report writing and represent TBF publicly
- Data aggregation, entry, QA/QC protocols, and data analysis
- Manage and lead over 75 volunteer AAUS scientific divers and lead recruiting efforts

Program Coordinator - Ocean Resiliency Program *September 2023 – November 2025*

- Coordinate subtidal scientific diving operations focused on *Macrocystis pyrifera* (giant kelp) restoration, endangered and threatened *Haliotis* species (abalone) recovery, and *Zostera* species (eelgrass) research
- Supervise and perform laboratory maintenance and project activities for *Haliotis* species spawning and rearing
- Data aggregation, entry, QA/QC protocols, and data analysis
- Implement maintenance of equipment and supplies utilized by the organization, including field, lab, boat, and SCUBA
- Created, grew, and coordinate a volunteer AAUS scientific diving program with over 75 onboarded divers

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Field Technician - Ocean Resiliency Program *September 2022 – September 2023*

- Conducted SCUBA based surveys, data collection, specimen collection, deployment and maintenance of field instruments/equipment, and underwater photography
- Supported managers with data entry, QAQC, and data analysis
- Maintained TBF infrastructure including research vessel, dive gear, field and lab equipment

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University of Southern California; Resource Diver *January 2022 – Present*

- Help train and certify new AAUS scientific divers at Wrigley Marine Science Center
- Serve as a dive master and assist with seminars

Independent Research Project, University of Southern California *May 2022*

- Used clod cards to analyze the difference in benthic water flow between a *Macrocystis pyrifera* and an *Sargassum horneri* dominant environment. The experiment sought to expose potential changes in water flow caused by sargassum invading Catalina Island and speculate about potential changes to the biodiversity/coastal ecology of Big Fisherman's Cove in the future.

Friends of the Ballona Wetlands; Restoration Intern *January – May 2022*

- Actively helped restore the wetlands and contributed to scientific data collection using transects
- Helped with subsequent data analysis

Research on the R/V Yellowfin *August – December 2021*

- Collected water samples on the Yellowfin research vessel to investigate and measure nitrate and chlorophyll levels at three different depths at three separate locations
- Utilized R statistical software to analyze research cruise data

Orange County Coastkeeper; Internship *January – May 2021*

- Worked as a research and advocacy intern with Ray Hiemstra of Orange Country Coastkeeper conducting environmental outreach work
- Utilized proficiency in photoshop to create flyers and infographics that were distributed to the public for two separate projects
- Assisted with the 'Stop Poseidon Project', making cold calls to gain support, submitted public comments, and spoke at the public hearing about the proposed desalination plant

Independent Research Project, University of Southern California *August – December 2020*

- Collected video data from various beaches along the southern California coast and analyzed the different topographies of these beaches
- Investigated impacts of the bathymetry and the effect on the ecology of the marine ecosystem
- Hypothesized about the likelihood of human and shark interactions in these different topographies
- Utilized R statistical software to analyze and elucidate how people can interact with marine systems by understanding underlying ecology

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El Porto Shark; Internship

August – December 2020

- Worked with shark research scientist, Apryl Boyle, to analyze data collected by Californian surfers
- Used for a 2021 National Geographic Shark Fest show aimed at destigmatizing sharks and showing how people can coexist with them

CONTRIBUTIONS

Palos Verdes Kelp Forest Restoration Project: Project Year 10: July 2022 – June 2023. The Bay Foundation, February 2024.

Palos Verdes Kelp Forest Restoration Project: Project Year 11: July 2023 – June 2024. The Bay Foundation, February 2025.

Palos Verdes Kelp Forest Restoration Project: Project Year 12: July 2024 – June 2025. The Bay Foundation, February 2026.

PRESENTATIONS

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA, Scientific Diving Seminar and Young Alumni Career Panel, 2024

- Comprehensive overview of The Bay Foundation projects, personal experience as a professional in environmental science, and recruitment for volunteer diving program.

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA LOS ANGELES, Scientific Diving Seminar, 2024

- Comprehensive overview of The Bay Foundation projects and personal experience as a professional in environmental science.

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA, Guest Lecturer for ENST 540: California Coastal Zone Science and Policy, 2025

- Provided insight on how my work for an NGO doing environmental restoration relates to California coastal policy and management.

WESTERN SOCIETY OF NATURALISTS, *Kelp Needs Your Help: Santa Monica Bay AAUS Volunteer Diving Opportunity*, 2025

- Gave a 5-minute speed talk on my volunteer diving program at The Bay Foundation hoping to recruit new divers and report on what we have accomplished over the last two years.

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CERTIFICATIONS

- AAUS Certified Scientific Diver
 - o 550+ AAUS scientific dives in the Southern California Bight
- NAUI Dive Master
- Nitrox Certified
- 120ft AAUS depth certification
- DAN First Aid, AED, CPR, and Oxygen Provider for Professional Divers
- HAZMAT fill station operator

SKILLS

- Data entry, database QA/QC, database management, and experimental design
- SCUBA based surveys, e.g. CRANE, urchin density surveys, fish surveys
- Experience and proficiency operating a 28ft research vessel
- Experience with environmental public education and outreach
- Some academic experience with R coding and data analysis
- Time management skills
- Dedicated contributing team member, both professionally and athletically
- Competent field and lab worker
- Fast learner

GRANTS/FELLOWSHIPS

- ARI NextGen Fellowship Cohort 3 2025: \$10,000
- Graduate Student Research Award: \$400